



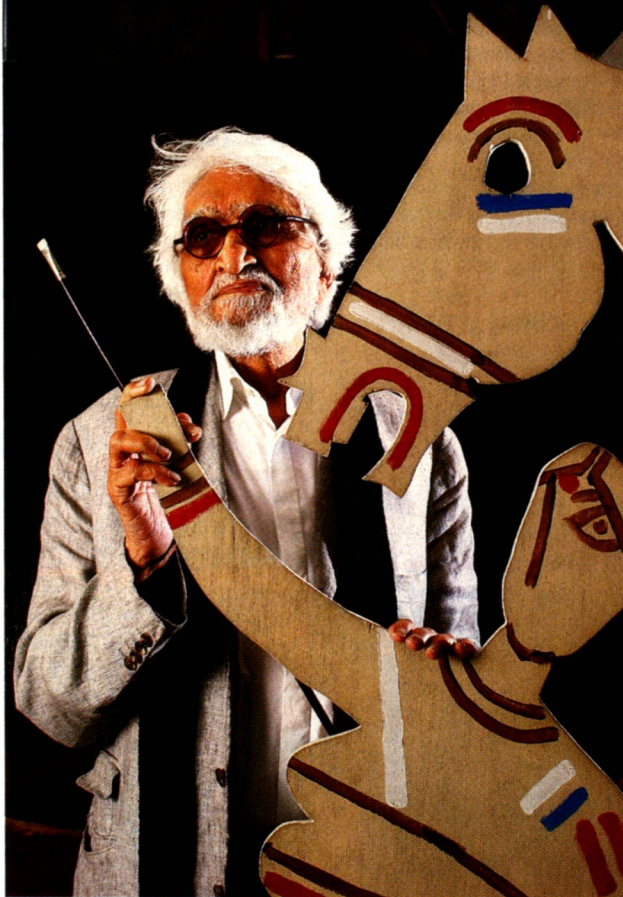
5 Treasured Affair Picasso in India

"The walls of the National Museum have not hung anything of this scale. Ever since Pablo Picasso arrived from France—on three Air France flights last week in insulated, foam-stuffed boxes weighing a total of six tonnes—neither the French Embassy officials in Delhi nor the Culture Department in the Ministry of Culture mandarins have breathed easy," observed INDIA TODAY in December 2001. Conceived during discussions between Jacques Chirac and I.K. Gujral and curated by Marie-Laure Bernadac as well as Saryu Doshi, *Metamorphoses*, Picasso's first-ever solo show, brought to India 122 of his greatest works from various collections. Much of it had never left the shores of France.

HEMANT CHAWLA

6 Selling it Big India's Biggest Art Deal

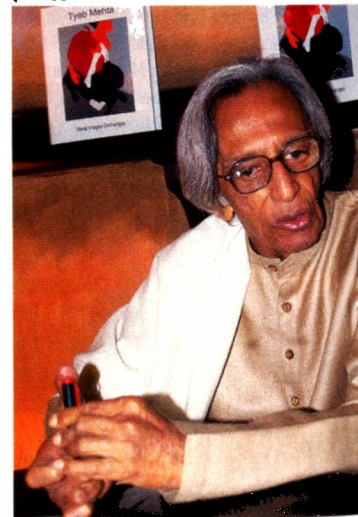
M.F. Husain, often considered the father of Indian contemporary art, has continued to be single-handedly responsible for driving art prices in India. In 1984, he made history by selling his work for Rs 1 crore, something unheard of then. In 2004, businessman G.S. Srivastava made news when he signed a Rs 100-crore deal with Husain for 100 canvases. "Srivastava has done so, not for the love of art, but on the advice of an investment banker who convinced him that Husain the brand is now growing into Husain Inc.," said INDIA TODAY in October 2005. That the deal came to naught, and only 25 paintings were sold for Rs 25 lakh did not take the sheen off from the biggest art deal ever brokered in India.



7 New Insight Christie's Auction

Breaking free of its shackles, Indian art came of age with prices skyrocketing. It had taken more than half a century and with most of the painters in the dusk of their lives, before acknowledgement in the international marketplace finally arrived. "It took only 160 seconds for the auctioneer to bring down the gavel on a whopping record Rs 7-

QAMAR SIBTAIN



crore sale price on a Tyeb Mehta painting (*Mahishasura*) at Christie's in New York last week," said INDIA TODAY in October 2005. At the same auction, an M.F. Husain painting, *Mahabali*, too shattered the barrier, picking up \$107,550, making it a benchmark auction.

F.N. SOUZA'S *BIRTH* SOLD FOR A WHOPPING RS 11.25 CRORE AT CHRISTIE'S IN 2008.